



POLESTAR APAC WEEKLY - 2026-09-19

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

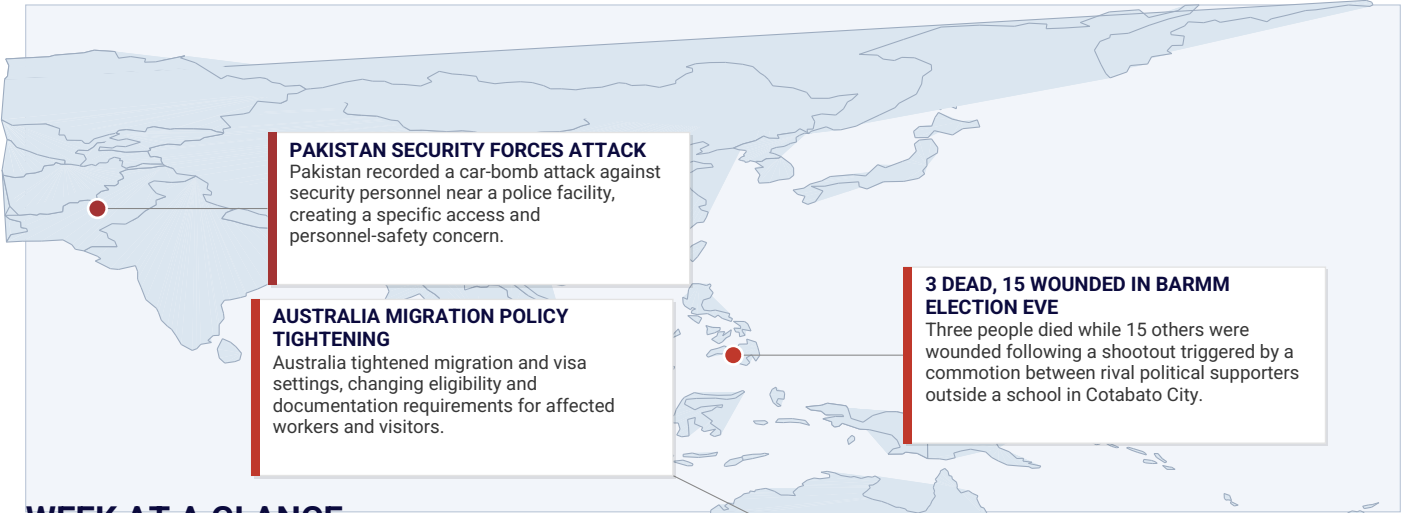
REPORTING PERIOD: 13 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 19 SEPTEMBER 2026

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REGIONAL OUTLOOK

APAC changed through armed conflict and access, security & conflict, regulatory & policy, cyber & information risk, business & operational disruption in Pakistan, Australia, Philippines, Thailand, Malaysia. Current reporting points to personnel and travel, sites and assets, compliance and market access, political exposure, transport and supply chains: Pakistan: Pakistan recorded a car-bomb attack against security personnel near a police facility, creating a specific access and personnel-safety concern Australia: Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors Philippines: Three people died while 15 others were wounded following a shootout triggered by a commotion between rival political supporters outside a school in Cotabato City on the eve of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) parliamentary elections Thailand: NARATHIWAT - An unknown number of assailants detonated a bomb and opened fire on a six-wheel truck carrying territorial defence volunteers in Sukhirin district of this southern border province on Friday afternoon.

REGIONAL RISK MAP



WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS 5	MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH 5
HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS 4	7-DAY WATCH ITEMS 3

REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The regional risk picture is limited to Pakistan, Australia, Philippines, Thailand, Malaysia and the domains evidenced this week: Security & Conflict, Regulatory & Policy, Armed Conflict and Access, Business & Operational Disruption, Cyber & Information Risk. The operating channels are personnel and travel, sites and assets, compliance and market access, political exposure, transport and supply chains. Pakistan (Security & Conflict): Pakistan recorded a car-bomb attack against security personnel near a police facility, creating a specific access and personnel-safety concern. Australia (Regulatory & Policy): Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors. Philippines (Armed Conflict and Access): Three people died while 15 others were wounded following a shootout triggered by a commotion between rival political supporters outside a school in Cotabato City on the eve of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) parliamentary elections. Thailand (Business & Operational Disruption): NARATHIWAT - An unknown number of assailants detonated a bomb and opened fire on a six-wheel truck carrying territorial defence volunteers in Sukhirin district of this southern border province on Friday afternoon. Malaysia (Cyber & Information Risk): Malaysia saw violence, military activity or access restrictions near affected routes or sites.

DEVELOPMENTS BY TYPE

Security	1
Regulatory	1
Armed Conflict	1
Operational Disruption	1
Cyber	1

DEVELOPMENTS BY MARKET

Pakistan	1
Australia	1
Philippines	1
Thailand	1
Malaysia	1

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

Pakistan | Pakistan security forces attack

Category: Security
Current Severity: Extreme
Assessment: Pakistan recorded a car-bomb attack against security personnel near a police facility, creating a specific access and personnel-safety concern.
Polestar View: Commercial risk rises if violence reaches transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss.

3 corroborating sources

Australia | Australia migration policy tightening

Category: Regulatory
Current Severity: High
Assessment: Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors.
Polestar View: This is a transition risk: the business effect will be set by the implementation timetable and the practical interpretation of new eligibility rules.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable.

Philippines | 3 dead, 15 wounded in BARMM election eve clash over

Category: Armed Conflict
Current Severity: High
Assessment: Three people died while 15 others were wounded following a shootout triggered by a commotion between rival political supporters outside a school in Cotabato City on the eve of the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) parliamentary elections.
Polestar View: Commercial risk rises if violence reaches transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss.

Thailand | Bomb, shooting attack on defence volunteer truck in Narathiwat

Category: Operational Disruption
Current Severity: High
Assessment: NARATHIWAT - An unknown number of assailants detonated a bomb and opened fire on a six-wheel truck carrying territorial defence volunteers in Sukhirin district of this southern border province on Friday afternoon.
Polestar View: Commercial risk rises if violence reaches transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss.

Malaysia | Malaysia maritime route disruption

Category: Cyber
Current Severity: Low
Assessment: Malaysia saw violence, military activity or access restrictions near affected routes or sites.
Polestar View: Commercial risk rises if violence reaches transport corridors, population centres or operating sites, or if authorities impose wider access restrictions.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss.

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

Pakistan, Australia, Philippines, Thailand, Malaysia: People and Travel: Pakistan: The immediate exposure is movement and site access near affected routes; the regional effect depends on persistence, spread and restrictions on commercial movement. Australia: The measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories. Operations and Assets: Pakistan: The immediate exposure is movement and site access near affected routes; the regional effect depends on persistence, spread and restrictions on commercial movement. Philippines: The immediate exposure is movement and site access near affected routes; the regional effect depends on persistence, spread and restrictions on commercial movement. Regulatory and market-access: Australia: The measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories.

7 DAY WATCH

2026-09-20 | Tokyo, Japan | "Protest the chaotic politics" street action, 1500-1630 in the Shinjuku pedestrian zone

The planned gathering may affect access or security around Tokyo, Japan. Current severity: High. Track venue advisories, organiser confirmation and any police restrictions.

2026-09-20 | Sendai, Japan | Gaza / Palestine street march, 1600-1730 from Kakyo-in Green Space

Movement and access in Sendai, Japan may be affected by the scheduled activity. Current severity: Moderate. Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

2026-09-20 | Islamabad, Pakistan | Jamaat-e-Islami threatens march on Islamabad on September 20

Movement and access in Islamabad, Pakistan may be affected by the scheduled activity. Current severity: Moderate. Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

APAC forward risk is tied to the unresolved conditions in Pakistan, Australia, Philippines, Thailand, Malaysia. Pakistan: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss. Australia: Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable. Philippines: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss. Thailand: Next seven days: track border notices, route restrictions, further clashes and credible indicators of displacement or access loss.

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